

When you don't know what to say

You want to say something and everything sounds wrong. Good. That instinct is correct; most of what people say in these moments is wrong. Here are three passages that ask nothing of the person, and three sentences that are honest. Say one. Then be quiet.

THREE PASSAGES

Psalm 34:18

“Yahweh is near to those who have a broken heart, and saves those who have a crushed spirit.”

John 11:35

“Jesus wept.”

Isaiah 43:2

“When you pass through the waters, I will be with you, and through the rivers, they will not overflow you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be burned, and flame will not scorch you.”

WHAT TO SAY

- “I don't have anything wise to say. I just wanted to be here.”
- “I'm not going to ask how you are. I'm going to bring dinner Tuesday.”
- “I keep thinking about [name].”

HOW TO USE THIS

Pick one passage and one sentence. That is a complete visit.